Effects of Social Media on Student Learning at the College of Business, Systems Plus College Foundation

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Abstract

Social media usage continues to grow in popularity especially among the youth and students in particular, it is the intent of this research to determine the usage and its effect on the learning of students as technology is perceived to be a vital part in today's student success equation. The various literatures lead us to the basic question on the adoption of social media as a tool to enhance learning capabilities of students. In hindsight, two schools of thought emerge on the effect of social media. It state the negative and positive effect of social media which ranges from students are having a harder time getting to communicate face to face with people, and are losing their people skills, due to spending more time talking from behind a screen. It was further assumed the attention to details, attention to pronunciation and grammar, has declined drastically, due to that most of the communication that happens online is not proper. On the other hand, social media improved ability to absorb information, Social media helped students have a better direction of what they want, now they have ease of reaching to mentors in the same industry and people already working in their dream company, and get a taste of what it is like. The study was focused on student's level of usage on various social media that are relevant to their learning at the College of Business, Systems Plus College Foundation. It will be highlighting on how social media affects the learning process through promoting, collaboration and information sharing from among the respondents, as well as perception how they used in academic settings to promote student engagement and facilitate better student learning. This descriptive, exploratory research study used random sampling using questionnaires to determine the perception on how social media affects students. Results will help educators in framing and designing their teaching methodologies using social media to achieve a higher level of learning.

Keywords: Social media; student learning; higher education; interactive learning; SPCF

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Introduction

Undeniably, in the rapid technological development and acclimatization of various stakeholders and beneficiaries, paves way the development of social media in the new millennium. Friendster went live in 2002, Facebook in 2004 and other social networking websites (Schiffman, 2008). Due to proliferation of a more compact and mobile gadgets that are more affordable, (e.g. tab, PDA, android-based and other operating system platforms for mobile phones) resulted to an exponential increase in the number of users from professionals and even to non-professionals which include students.

According to Chan, the top 5 mobile messaging applications based on the number of registered users are: (1) WhatsApp with 450 million monthly users, it's clear why this US-based messaging giant has been the talk of the town and is now under Facebook's ownership. WhatsApp is still available for iOS, Android, Windows Phone, BlackBerry and Symbian platforms. (2) Viber with over 300 million registered members use this Cyprus-based app in February of 2014, Viber was bought by Japan-based e-commerce and Internet service company Rakuten for $900 million. (3) WeChat which is owned by China's Tencent, one of Chinas largest internet service providers, and has amassed a following of 450 million monthly users since its founding in 2010. (4) Line with their array of teen-friendly cartoon stickers, Japan's Naver-owned Line app boasts over 350 million registered users. (5) South Korea's KakaoTalk has over 100 million registered users. This messaging app partnered with Evernote in 2013, in an effort to integrate the US service onto the KakaoTalk mobile app. In addition, the most popular Facebook is also made available in almost all mobile platforms.

It is apparent that usage of social media is prevalent however, most often than not, its application is mostly personal in nature and informal. The driving factors for adoption of social media are the progressively ubiquitous access, convenience, functionality, and flexibility of social technologies (Brown, S. (2010) (Schroeder, A., Minocha, S., & Schneider, C. (2010). Prevalence of social media applications like Facebook and WhatsApp creates an endless

opportunities and applications. Academic applications of social media are gaining much attention and studies have conducted the possible impact of social media on the student performance. According to Fageeh (2011), technology in and of itself does nothing to improve student academic achievement, but it can bring about changes in motivation and attitude, which are instrumental for enhancing academic achievement. Equip with the latest technology in terms of educational equipment, applications and tools, that is matched with the appropriate student learning styles increases the level of understanding and ultimately the quality of education (Mirano, 2014).

Purpose and Significance of the Study

This study is conducted in order to determine social media usage of the students and its effect on students' learning as perceived by the students of the College of Business, Systems Plus College Foundation as a basis for establishing a supplementary media aside from the traditional classroom technique to promote higher academic standing, achievement and satisfaction. In addition, this study is significant for the following stakeholders:

- Systems Plus College Foundation to review and enact new policy with the use of social media applications (i.e. Facebook and WhatsApp) as a learning tools at the institution.
- College of Business for the attainment of higher student satisfaction level and learning and at the same time more efficient and cost effective information dissemination alternative.
- Faculty and students for a more convenient and accessible means of sharing ideas, and information through discussion forums and comments.
- Students to reach higher level of academic achievement, standing and satisfaction.

Research questions

As the title of implies, this study would be able to:

- Determine the students' ability to participate through Facebook and/or WhatsApp through the availability and ownership of compatible handheld devices and internet accessibility.

- Determine the students' level of adaptability or convenience in using social media applications (Facebook and WhatsApp).
- Generalize students' perceptions on their level of learning through social media applications with special reference to gender.

Methodology

The researcher will used descriptive, exploratory research in undertaking this study due to non-existence of published research in within Philippine context. Both primary and secondary data will be used particularly survey questionnaire and other published and unpublished study related to this topic.

The survey questionnaires will be randomly distributed to students based on the researchers' convenience and data were analyzed with the aid of SPSS (Statistics Package for Social Sciences).

Review of Related Literature

Participation in social media creates a more collaborative and communicative learning environment for students by providing opportunities for discussions and interactions with their peers (Heafner & Friedman, 2008; Jackson, 2011; Liu et al., 2011). Nelson Laird and Kuh (2005) also reported that students who use information technology for academics have a higher likelihood of contributing and participating in active, academic collaboration with other students. This collaboration indicates that as engagement with technology increases, engagement with academics also increases, promoting a deeper connection between the students, educators, and course content (Mehdinezhad, 2011). As a result, social media supports collaborative learning, which in turn helps to strengthen the creative learning process (Shoshani & Rose Braun, 2007).

However, Arnold and Paulus (2010) found that even when social media is used for an educational purpose, students incorporate the technology into their lives in a way that may differ from the intentions of the course instructor. Thus, this suggests that establishing standards for social media use should include behavior and attitude guidelines similar to those enforced in the classroom (Tarantino, McDonough, Hua, n.d.).

Research Timeline:

	Activities	Date	Remarks
1	Writing of Research Proposal (topic, planning of activities)	June 2016	Meet Research Unit
2	Approval/ Evaluation of Resources Needed	July 2016	Planned for printing of questionnaires, identified respondents
3	Writing of Introduction, Review of Literature	August 2016	Gather materials
4	Research Methodology	September 2016	Pre-test questionnaire
5	Data Gathering	September-December, 2016	Questionnaire administered through students
6	Data Analysis and Interpretations	January-February, 2016	Statistical treatment of data
7	Findings, Recommendations, Conclusion	March 2016	Brainstorming
8	Final Draft	March 2016	Encoding of draft paper
9	Presentation	April 2016	Colloquium